

Adult Education and Employment Resources

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College Classes & Programs: English Language, ABE, and I-BEST

[Community and Technical Colleges in Washington State](#) offer several classes and programs for people who want to improve their skills, prepare for college-level coursework, and prepare for employment.



English language classes (\$25/quarter) are for English language learners who want to develop their English speaking, listening, reading, and writing skills. Classes range from beginning to advanced level.

ABE classes (\$25/quarter) are for people who want to develop their reading, writing, and math skills to earn a GED or high school diploma, get a job or advance in a job, or prepare for college.

I-BEST (full college tuition) stands for Integrated Basic Education and Skills Training. Students improve their reading, writing, math, and communication skills while training for a specific job. Students can train to become an accountant, mechanic, machinist, office assistant, preschool teacher, nursing assistant, and more! Search a database of I-BEST programs here: <https://ibestprograms.sbctc.edu/>

For all college classes and programs, financial aid is available for those who meet eligibility requirements.

- **Bellevue College** Bellevue, WA
English: eslbats@bellevuecollege.edu; <https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/esl/>
ABE: abe@bellevuecollege.edu; <https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/abe/>
I-BEST: ibest@bellevuecollege.edu; <https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/i-best/>
- **Lake Washington Institute of Technology** Kirkland, WA
English: 425-739-8359; <https://www.lwtech.edu/academics/english-language-learning.aspx>
ABE: 425-739-8100 <https://www.lwtech.edu/academics/basic-education-for-adults/>
I-BEST: 425-739-8100 ext. 8567; <https://www.lwtech.edu/academics/i-best/>
- **Shoreline Community College** Shoreline, WA
English: esl@shoreline.edu; 206-705-8725; <https://www.shoreline.edu/transitional-studies/ell/default.aspx>
ABE: abe@shoreline.edu; 206-705-8725; <https://www.shoreline.edu/transitional-studies/adult-basic-education/default.aspx>
I-BEST: mlockman@shoreline.edu; 206-546-6930; <https://www.shoreline.edu/transitional-studies/ibest/>



- Cascadia College** Bothell, WA
English: 425-352-8158; eslabe@cascadia.edu; <https://www.cascadia.edu/academic-programs/college-and-career-foundations/esl.aspx>
ABE: 425-352-8158; eslabe@cascadia.edu; <https://www.cascadia.edu/academic-programs/college-and-career-foundations/abe.aspx>
I-BEST: No I-BEST programs
 
- Edmonds College** Lynnwood, WA
English: 425-640-1478; en Español 425.640.1040 (in Spanish); elaadvising@edmonds.edu
<https://www.edcc.edu/programs/inted/ela/>
ABE (College and Career Prep) 425-640-1593; precollege@edmonds.edu; <https://www.edmonds.edu/programs-and-degrees/pre-college/college-and-career-prep/default.html>
I-BEST: 425-640-1593; ibest@edmonds.edu; <https://www.edmonds.edu/programs-and-degrees/pre-college/ibest/default.html>

- Renton Technical College** Renton, WA
English: 206-880-1704; askccp@rtc.edu; <https://www.rtc.edu/learn-english>
ABE: 206-880-1704; <https://www.rtc.edu/academics/areas-of-study/college-career-pathways/Adult-Basic-Education.php>
I-BEST: 425-235-2319; <https://rtc.edu/academics/areas-of-study/college-career-pathways/i-best.php>

- North Seattle College** Seattle, WA
English: 206-934-4720; Sarka.Faltinova@seattlecolleges.edu;
<https://northseattle.edu/programs/esl>
ABE: 206-934-4537; Shan.Lackey@seattlecolleges.edu; <https://northseattle.edu/programs/transitional-studies-abe-ged-high-school-college-prep>
I-BEST: 206-934-6030; Nyah.Ferreira@seattlecolleges.edu; <https://northseattle.edu/basic-and-transitional-studies/i-best>

- Seattle Central College** Seattle, WA
English: <https://seattlecentral.edu/programs/basic-and-transitional-studies/esl>; 206-934-4180
 btsinfo@seattlecolleges.edu
ABE: <https://seattlecentral.edu/programs/basic-and-transitional-studies>; dino.kladouris@seattlecolleges.edu
I-BEST: TBA
 
- South Seattle College** Seattle, WA
English: <https://southseattle.edu/transitional-studies/english-second-language-esl>
ABE: SouthTS@seattlecolleges.edu; 206-934-5363; <https://southseattle.edu/transitional-studies>
I-BEST: southproftech@seattlecolleges.edu; 206-934-5394; <https://southseattle.edu/transitional-studies/i-best-career-training>

- Highline College** Des Moines, WA
English: elcapofficestaff@highline.edu; cknighon@highline.edu; <https://www.highline.edu/academics-pathways/learn-english.html>
ABE: <https://elcap.highline.edu/what-we-offer/>
I-BEST: <https://elcap.highline.edu/what-we-offer/i-best/>


Community Classes: English Language, ABE, Citizenship, Computer

There are several classes in the community available to adult learners. Classes are free, except for at Westminster Language Academy. English Language Learners Alliance (ELLA), libraries, and Westminster Language Academy do not have any visa restrictions, so they can serve people who are in the United States on a short-term basis.



- **Hopelink English for Work**, King County
<https://www.hopelink.org/need-help/adult-education>
- **English Language Learners Alliance (ELLA)** Bellevue, WA
English conversation practice and classes in-person and online; 425-312-3552; ellallianceinfo@gmail.com
<http://www.ellalliance.org/>
- **Public Libraries** King County, WA
Talk Time/English conversation classes, Citizenship prep classes, drop-in tutoring, and more
King County Library System: <https://kcls.org/adult-learners/>
Seattle Public Library System: <https://www.spl.org/programs-and-services/learning/learn-english>
- **Westminster Language Academy** 13646 NE 24th Street, Bellevue, WA 98005 (at Westminster Chapel)
English classes and private tutoring
425-460-4041; wla-info@westminster.org; <https://westminsterlanguageacademy.org/>
- **Goodwill** King County, WA
English classes and computer/digital literacy classes
Seattle: 206-860-5791; <https://evergreengoodwill.org/locations/job-training-education-center-king-county/>
Renton: 425 264-0277; <https://evergreengoodwill.org/locations/renton-goodwill/>
Shoreline: 206-631-8454; <https://evergreengoodwill.org/locations/shoreline-goodwill/>
- **Casa Latina** 317 17th Avenue South Seattle, WA 98144
English classes and computer/digital literacy classes; learning@casa-latina.org
<https://casa-latina.org/work/english-classes/>; <https://www.facebook.com/casalatinaenglish>

Free Job Training Programs

- **BankWork\$ Fundamentals:** Online
Eight-week training for careers in banking
866-500-4443; fundamentals@careerworkstraining.org
<https://www.careerworks.org/programs/bankworks-fundamentals/> <https://www.careerworks.org/contact-us/>

- **MediWork\$:** Seattle, WA
Eight-week training for non-clinical, entry-level positions in healthcare
206-317-1017; lniggemyer@careerpathservices.org
<https://www.careerworks.org/programs/mediworks/>

- **FareStart:** Seattle, WA
12-week culinary training program for adults who want to work in food service
206-787-1502; enroll@farestart.org; <https://www.farestart.org/job-training/food-pathways-program/>

- **Goodwill:** King County, WA
Offers cashiering and customer service training
Seattle: 206-860-5791; <https://evergreengoodwill.org/locations/job-training-education-center-king-county/>
Shoreline: 206-631-8454; <https://evergreengoodwill.org/locations/shoreline-goodwill/>

- **Year Up United:** Seattle, WA
One-year career preparation program; students can learn about business operations, project management, IT, computer networking and support, database analysis and more. Must be age 18-29.
admissions@yearupunited.org; 855-932-7871
<https://www.yearup.org/job-training> | <https://www.yearup.org/locations/seattle-wa>


Free Employment Resources



- **Welcome Back Center at Highline College** Des Moines, WA
Career and education planning for immigrants and refugees who graduated from college outside of the U.S.
206-592-3670; welcomebackcenter@highline.edu; <http://welcomeback.highline.edu/>
- **WorkSource:** WA state
Job search help, hiring events, job search workshops, and more. Open to all job seekers.
<https://www.worksourcewa.com/>
- **Lake Washington Institute of Technology Employment Resource Center:** Kirkland, WA
Career exploration workshops offered at various times. Individual appointments are also available. Open to all job seekers.
425-739-8113; career.services@lwtech.edu; <https://www.lwtech.edu/campus-services/career-services/index.aspx>

- **Center for Career Connections and The Women's Center at Bellevue College:** Bellevue, WA
Classes, workshops and career planning services. Open to all job seekers.
425-564-2279; careers@bellevuecollege.edu; <https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/careers/>
- **Upwardly Global** Online only
Upwardly Global's FREE online learning resources help you, a professionally focused and work-authorized immigrant or refugee, get back to work in your professional field.
Contact Kate Johnson at 425-559-5228; kjohnson@hopelink.org
Link to flyer: <https://tinyurl.com/3fv89p98>

Pre-Apprenticeship and Apprenticeship Programs



Pre-apprenticeship helps people build confidence and skills to prepare for apprenticeship. Apprenticeship is a combination of on-the-job training (OJT) and classroom instruction. Workers learn the practical skills and theoretical knowledge of an occupation while earning a living-wage salary. Workers may also earn college credit, depending on the program. Use this database to see apprenticeship programs in Washington state: <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/arts-public/#/>.

- **Apprenti** Seattle, WA
Apprenticeship programs to help people prepare for various careers in Information Technology including software developer, database administrator, web developer, cloud support specialist, and more
425-270-2128; info@apprenticareers.org; <https://apprenticareers.org>
- **ANew** Tukwila, WA
Pre-apprenticeship training to help people enter careers in construction trades
<https://anewcareer.org/programs/pre-apprenticeship-trades-rotation-training-program/>
- **Seattle City Light** Seattle, WA
Pre-apprenticeship program to prepare people to become line workers; apprenticeship programs to prepare people to become cable splicers, meter electricians, and more
206-386-1603; scl_apprenticeship@seattle.gov
<http://www.seattle.gov/city-light/about-us/careers/apprenticeships>
- **Construction Industry Training Council of Washington** Bellevue, WA
Apprenticeship programs to prepare people to become electricians, plumbers, painters, and more
425-454-2482; <https://citcwa.org/apprenticeship/>
- **Pre-Apprenticeship Construction Training (PACT)** Seattle, WA
Certificate program to gain skills to enter construction trade apprenticeships
Jerry Jordan 206-934-4942; jerry.jordan@seattlecolleges.edu
<https://woodtech.seattlecentral.edu/programs/pre-apprenticeship-construction-training>
- **Machinists Institute** Tukwila and Everett, WA
Pre-apprenticeship classes and apprenticeship programs in aerospace, automotive, manufacturing and machinist industries. General: 206-331-4648; <https://www.machinistsinstitute.org/>
Tukwila: Marcus Harrell marcus.harrell@machinistsinstitute.org; ttc@machinistsinstitute.org
Everett: etc@machinistsinstitute.org